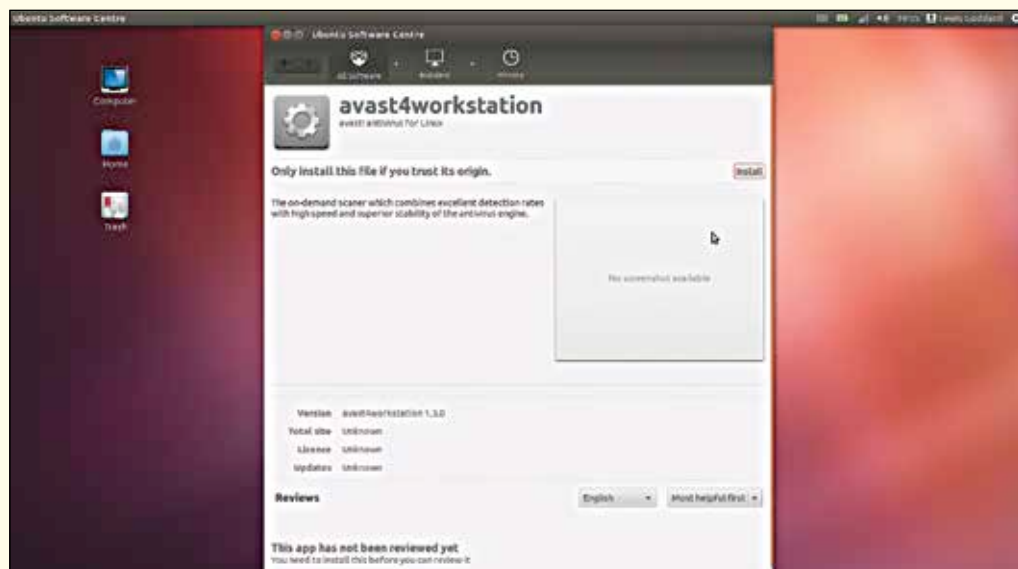


malware or viruses. A slow computer would be one sign. This is because your system processes are being used by other malicious software. On occasion, your computer would restart for no rhyme or reason. Another sign would be the fact that certain windows features that help you manually remove the malware would cease to work like your Registry Editor (regedit), Task Manager (taskmgr.exe), Command Prompt (cmd.exe), System configuration utility (msconfig), Group Policy Editor (gpedit.msc). If this happens, move on to disinfection. Other telltale signs include your web browser starts acting up by giving you search results which have nothing at all to do with what you were actually searching for. Installed programs start crashing randomly or start behaving in an odd manner. Sometimes, Microsoft Update starts giving you error messages, and the official websites would be inaccessible.

The clincher of a sign that your PC is infected is your antivirus starts acting up and nothing you do it would make it work. Websites which offer antiviruses won't let you download any programs either.

Disclaimer: Please note that BSOD is very rarely a sign of virus attacks. It's mostly a result of your hardware being in a state of disrepair.



Avast on Ubuntu



Disinfect via safemode

The most common method usually involves rebooting your PC in safe mode. This is mainly because this helps during troubleshooting various software and your operating system as a whole. Keep in mind that in some cases the user is denied the option to boot in Safe Mode or Safe mode with Networking. This would mean your infection has spread too far, and you need to try one of the other (possibly radical) measure mentioned in the tips that follow.

Booting the computer in 'safe mode' or 'safe mode with networking' ensures that the PC loads only the basic and absolutely necessary system drivers and services. These

steps are a lot more effective because there is a much better chance that the virus will not be loaded at startup. The 'safe mode with networking' option lets you download the required security software to run a full scan for viruses and clean the system.

Keep in mind that when disinfecting with this method, it is imperative that your account has Administrator rights.



Get into safe mode

To enter Safe Mode, boot your computer and press F8 before Windows starts loading to enter the Windows boot menu. Use this menu to access Safe Mode. When you reach that menu, select Safe Mode with

Networking from the list of boot options. Booting with Networking is recommended — it's better if you have internet access to solve your virus problem. Once your PC has booted in Safe Mode, open Internet Explorer. Yes, we know we're all fans of Chrome and/or Firefox, and most of us may have even removed IE from our system, but it's an unfortunate fact that using any other browser while running Windows in safe mode often causes more problems than it tries to solve. So grow up, get online and download a reliable antivirus software to try and clean your PC. We would suggest Avast! or AVG if you don't intend to spend any money in this process. Either

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*Condition apply. All specification are subject to change without notice. Product availability may vary by region.
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